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Dogon games

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Culture (OWC): [Dogon \(FA16\)](#)

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Place Coverage

Sanga; Bandiagara Circle, Mopti Region, Mali

Section Title(S): JIBES BETWEEN STRANGERS.

The foreseen jibe is an honest way to evade having to go by the rules, to make a break with politeness, to compensate oneself with a real joy for all the troubles which have been gone to in the observation of customs vis-a-vis one's neighbors (2); it is an efficacious vengeance for him who pursues it, but in the final analysis an inoffensive joke for the one is the object of it. A natural reaction, it puts into equilibrium the activity of the group as a whole.

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It is said that in the olden days the people of Ireli ate raw meat; when a man cooked it for the first time, it was a real event.

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The people of Sanga mock the people of Ireli by saying:

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yogo ireli s_o yakoh[unknown]
ad[unknown]n[unknown] `na ku diana.
Tomorrow there will be tales at Ireli
Because (someone named) Adene has cooked an Ox's head.
Sanga.

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According to the people of Sanga, the villages of Yendoumman were built upon ground that is without rocks, which to their eyes is an inconvenience, perhaps because of the termites which cannot live in a rocky place but swarm in the loose earth.

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In order to celebrate their superiority, the people of Sanga sing:

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yendummā de sāga ir[unknown]
 sāgana taba yak ,o.
 Sanga is worth more than Yendoumman
 At Sanga, there are rocks.

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It is worthy of mention that the villages of Yendoumman occupy the identical sites as those of the majority of the localities that are situated at the base of the cliff: screes of rocks with some areas of sandy earth.

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Sanga.

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In order to mock the people of Sangui, a village of Sangadu-Haut, one says:

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sāgi b[unknown]ō dull ,o kumuli soy.
 Those of Sangui have seven tails of baobab seeds.

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Another mockery: 223 236 cont.

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(2). It is not a matter here of expressions that are determined by the joking relationships that are observable in Dogon country, but simple jibes.

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